

WONDER

1. Passage anchor

> “...I think most people, at some point, **wonder whether** they could have lived differently.”

Passage meaning

wonder whether / if... = think about something because you are curious, uncertain, or trying to imagine the answer

想知道；思索；不禁想.....

Here, the speaker means people often think about alternate versions of their lives and ask themselves whether things could have turned out differently.

Practice

1. I sometimes **wonder whether** I made the right choice.

我有時會**想自己是否**作出了正確選擇。

2. She **wondered if** things would have been different.

她**不禁想**，如果當初不同，事情會不會也不同**。**

Core meanings of WONDER

2. wonder — think curiously about something

= think about something because you want to know or understand it

想知道；思考

Examples

1. I **wonder** what happened.

我**想知道**發生了甚麼。

2. She **wondered** why he had left so early.

她**想知道**他為甚麼那麼早離開。

This is the central verb sense.

3. wonder if / whether

= ask yourself mentally whether something is true or possible

****想知道是否..... ; 不禁想.....****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. I ****wonder if**** he remembers me.

我****想知道他是否****還記得我。

2. They ****wondered whether**** the plan would work.

他們****不禁想這個計畫是否****行得通。

4. wonder what / why / how / where

= think about an unknown answer or explanation

****想知道甚麼 / 為何 / 如何 / 在哪裡****

Examples

1. I ****wonder why**** she changed her mind.

我****想知道她為甚麼****改變主意。

2. He ****wondered how**** the machine worked.

他****想知道這部機器是怎樣運作的****。

Polite / indirect question use

5. I wonder if...

= polite way to ask or suggest something indirectly

****不知道是否可以..... ; 想請問.....****

Examples

1. ****I wonder if**** you could help me.

****不知道你可不可以****幫我。

2. ****I was wondering if**** you had a moment.

****想請問你是否有一點時間****。

This is not literal curiosity only; it is a common politeness strategy.

Noun: amazement / awe

6. wonder — feeling of amazement

= strong feeling of surprise, admiration, or awe

驚奇；驚嘆；讚嘆

Examples

1. She looked at the stars in **wonder**.

她帶著**驚嘆**仰望星空。

2. The children stared in **wonder**.

孩子們**驚奇地**盯著看。

Major noun sense.

7. with wonder / in wonder

= with a feeling of amazement or awe

驚奇地；驚嘆地

Examples

1. He watched the performance **in wonder**.

他**驚嘆地**觀看表演。

2. She listened **with wonder**.

她帶著**驚奇**聆聽。

Noun: remarkable thing

8. wonder — amazing thing

= something that causes admiration because it is extraordinary

奇觀；奇蹟般的事物；令人驚嘆之物

Examples

1. The building is an engineering **wonder**.

這座建築是工程上的**奇觀**。

2. The human brain is a **wonder** of nature.

人腦是大自然的一項**奇蹟般的創造**。

9. wonders

= remarkable achievements, sights, or phenomena

奇觀；**奇蹟**

Examples

1. The city is famous for its architectural **wonders**.

這座城市以建築**奇觀**聞名。

2. Modern medicine can work **wonders**.

現代醫學有時能創造**奇效**。

Work wonders

10. work wonders

= produce an excellent or surprisingly effective result

產生奇效；**非常有效**

Examples

1. A short break can **work wonders**.

短暫休息可以**非常有效**。

2. The new treatment **worked wonders** for her recovery.

新療法對她的康復**產生了奇效**。

Very high-value idiom.

No wonder

11. no wonder

= it is not surprising that...

****難怪；怪不得****

Examples

1. ****No wonder**** you're tired—you barely slept.

****難怪****你這麼累，你幾乎沒有睡。

2. ****No wonder**** the book stayed in her mind.

****難怪****這本書一直留在她心裡。

Very common fixed expression.

12. little wonder

= unsurprisingly; it is hardly surprising

****不足為奇；難怪****

Examples

1. ****Little wonder**** she was upset.

她感到難過****一點也不奇怪****。

2. ****Little wonder**** the idea became popular.

這個想法受歡迎****並不令人意外****。

More formal.

Wonder at

13. wonder at something

= feel amazement or admiration at something

****對……感到驚嘆****

Examples

1. We ****wondered at**** the size of the building.

我們對這棟建築的規模****感到驚嘆****。

2. She ****wondered at**** how quickly things had changed.

她對事情改變得如此之快****感到驚訝****。

Less common than verb **wonder + question clause**, but distinct.

Related forms

14. wonderful

= extremely good, enjoyable, or impressive

很棒的；精彩的；令人愉快的

Examples

1. We had a **wonderful** time.

我們度過了一段**很愉快的**時光。

2. That's a **wonderful** idea.

那是個**很棒的**想法。

Important semantic development: it usually means “excellent,” not literally “full of wonder.”

15. wonderfully

= extremely well or pleasantly

非常好地；精彩地

Examples

1. The plan worked **wonderfully**.

這個計畫進行得**非常順利**。

2. She sang **wonderfully**.

她唱得**非常精彩**。

16. wondrous

= causing wonder; extraordinary or marvelous

奇妙的；令人驚嘆的

Examples

1. They entered a **wondrous** landscape.
他們進入了一片**奇妙的景色**。
2. The story describes a **wondrous** world.
故事描寫了一個**奇妙的世界**。

More literary.

17. wonderment

= feeling of wonder or amazement

驚奇；驚嘆

Examples

1. The child stared in **wonderment**.
孩子帶著**驚奇**凝視著。
2. Her face showed pure **wonderment**.
她臉上露出純粹的**驚嘆**。

Less common but established.

High-value expressions

18. I wonder...

= I am curious / I am thinking about...

我想知道.....；我在想.....

Examples

1. **I wonder** what she meant.
我想知道她是甚麼意思。
2. **I wonder** where he went.
我想知道他去了哪裡。

19. it makes you wonder

= causes you to think, question, or become curious

****讓人不禁思考；令人懷疑****

Examples

1. The result ****makes you wonder**** what really happened.

這個結果****讓人不禁想****究竟發生了甚麼。

2. The story ****makes you wonder**** how different life could be.

這個故事****讓人不禁思考****人生可以有多不同。

Very relevant to reflective writing.

20. wonder of wonders

= something very surprising or remarkable

****真是奇事；奇蹟中的奇蹟****

Examples

1. ****Wonder of wonders****, he arrived early.

****真是奇事****，他竟然早到了。

2. ****Wonder of wonders****, the old machine still worked.

****真令人驚訝****，那部舊機器竟然還能運作。

Often humorous or ironic.

Key contrasts

21. wonder vs think

****think****

= general mental activity

****想；思考****

****wonder****

= think specifically because something is unknown, uncertain, or curious

****想知道；納悶****

Compare:

> I think he is right.

> 我認為他是對的。

> I wonder if he is right.

> 我想知道他是否是對的。

22. wonder vs ask

****ask****

= verbally or explicitly request information

****問****

****wonder****

= ask yourself mentally; you may not say anything aloud

****心裡想知道****

Compare:

> I asked where she was.

> 我問她在哪裡。

> I wondered where she was.

> 我心裡想她到底在哪裡。

23. wonder vs curiosity

****curiosity****

= desire to know something

****好奇心****

****wonder****

= act/state of thinking curiously or feeling amazement

****想知道；驚奇****

24. wonder vs surprise

****surprise****

= reaction to something unexpected

****驚訝****

****wonder****

= can include amazement plus admiration or awe

****驚奇；驚嘆****

Compare:

> surprise at the result

> 對結果感到驚訝

> wonder at the night sky

> 對夜空感到驚嘆

25. wonderful vs wondrous

****wonderful****

= usually “very good / excellent” in modern everyday English

****很棒的****

****wondrous****

= literally inspiring wonder; more literary

****奇妙的；令人驚嘆的****

Meaning map

The central idea of ****wonder**** is:

****the mind reacting to something unknown or remarkable****

This develops in two main directions:

Curiosity

wonder whether

→ ****想知道是否……****

Passage

wonder whether life could have been different

→ ****不禁思考人生是否本可不同****

Polite request

I wonder if you could...

→ **不知道你是否可以.....**

And:

Amazement

look in wonder

→ **驚嘆地看**

Remarkable thing

a wonder of nature

→ **自然奇觀**

Effectiveness

work wonders

→ **產生奇效**

Explanation

no wonder

→ **難怪**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
wonder — verb curiosity	因不知道答案而思考、想知道
wonder if/whether	想知道某事是否成立 / 可能；不禁想
wonder what/why/how/where	想知道某事的內容、原因、方法或位置
I wonder if... — polite	以較委婉方式提出要求、問題或建議
wonder — noun amazement	因非凡或美好事物產生的驚奇 / 驚嘆
in/with wonder	帶著驚奇、讚嘆地
wonder — remarkable thing	令人非常驚嘆的奇觀 / 非凡事物
wonders	令人驚嘆的景象、成果或事物
work wonders	產生非常好的效果；有奇效
no wonder	情況完全可以理解；難怪 / 怪不得
little wonder	不足為奇；難怪
wonder at something	對某事感到驚訝、驚嘆
wonderful	非常好、令人愉快或出色的
wonderfully	非常好地 / 精彩地
wondrous	令人驚嘆、奇妙的，較文學化

wonderment	驚奇、驚嘆的感受	
it makes you wonder	使人不禁思考 / 產生疑問	
wonder of wonders	非常令人意外的事情；真是奇事	

Passage recap

> “...most people, at some point, **wonder whether they could have lived differently**.”

Here:

wonder whether = **ask yourself mentally about an uncertain possibility**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **想知道是否.....**

* **不禁想.....**

* **思索是否.....**

Natural contextual translation:

我覺得大多數人在人生某個時刻，都會不禁想，自己是否本來可以活得不一樣。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

wonder whether / if

= **to think about something because you are curious or uncertain about whether it is true or possible**

想知道是否.....；不禁思考.....

The most important distinction is:

> **think that**

> → 認為某件事是真的

but:

> **wonder whether**

> → **不確定，所以在想到底是不是**

And the noun goes in a completely different direction:

> **look in wonder**

> → 驚嘆地看

> **a wonder of nature**

> → 自然奇觀

So **wonder** is a high-value word because it connects **curiosity/uncertainty** with **amazement/awe**, depending on grammar and context.